

Simponi ARIA (golimumab)



Pharmacy Coverage Policy

Effective Date: January 01, 2019

Revision Date: July 22, 2026

Review Date: July 15, 2026

Line of Business: Medicare, Medicaid - South Carolina

Policy Type: Prior Authorization

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Products Affected

Simponi ARIA intravenous solution

Listed Indications

[Ankylosing Spondylitis](#)

[Psoriatic Arthritis](#)

[Rheumatoid Arthritis](#)

[Polyarticular Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis](#)

Ankylosing Spondylitis

Does the member meet all of the following criteria?

Criteria #1	The member must have a diagnosis of active ankylosing spondylitis.
Criteria #2	The member must be at least 18 years of age or older
Criteria #3	The member has had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with at least one non-steroidal anti-inflammatory drug (NSAID) (e.g. ibuprofen, meloxicam, naproxen).

Does the member have any of the following exclusions? If yes, approval may not be appropriate.

NOTE: Experimental/Investigational Use – Indications not supported by CMS recognized compendia or acceptable peer reviewed literature.

Exclusion #1	Combination therapy with other biologics (e.g. Cosentyx, Enbrel, adalimumab product, Kevzara, Remicade).
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Approval Duration

Initial	Simponi Aria (golimumab) will be approved in plan year durations or as determined through clinical review.
Renewal	Simponi Aria (golimumab) will be approved in plan year durations or as determined through clinical review.

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Psoriatic Arthritis

Does the member meet all of the following criteria?

Criteria #1	The member must have a diagnosis of active psoriatic arthritis.
Criteria #2	The member must be at least 2 years of age or older
Criteria #3	The member has had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with an NSAID (e.g. meloxicam, ibuprofen, naproxen) AND the member has had prior therapy with or intolerance to a single DMARD (e.g. sulfasalazine, methotrexate, leflunomide) or contraindication to all DMARDs.

Does the member have any of the following exclusions? If yes, approval may not be appropriate.

NOTE: Experimental/Investigational Use – Indications not supported by CMS recognized compendia or acceptable peer reviewed literature.

Exclusion #1	Combination therapy with other biologics (e.g. Cosentyx, Enbrel, adalimumab product, Kevzara, Remicade).
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Rheumatoid Arthritis

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Does the member meet all of the following criteria?	
Criteria #1	The member must have a diagnosis of moderately to severely active rheumatoid arthritis.
Criteria #2	The member must be at least 18 years of age or older.
Criteria #3	The member has had prior therapy with or intolerance to a single DMARD (e.g. methotrexate, sulfasalazine, hydroxychloroquine, leflunomide) or contraindication to all DMARDs.
Criteria #4	The member must be on concomitant treatment with methotrexate during golimumab therapy, unless contraindicated or intolerant to methotrexate.
Does the member have any of the following exclusions? If yes, approval may not be appropriate.	
NOTE: Experimental/Investigational Use – Indications not supported by CMS recognized compendia or acceptable peer reviewed literature.	
Exclusion #1	Combination therapy with other biologics (e.g. Cosentyx, Enbrel, adalimumab product, Kevzara, Remicade).
Approval Duration	
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Polyarticular Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis	
Does the member meet all of the following criteria?	
Criteria #1	The member must have a diagnosis of active polyarticular Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis
Criteria #2	The member is 2 years of age or older
Criteria #3	The member has had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with a DMARD (e.g. methotrexate, cyclosporine, leflunomide)
Does the member have any of the following exclusions? If yes, approval may not be appropriate.	
NOTE: Experimental/Investigational Use – Indications not supported by CMS recognized compendia or acceptable peer reviewed literature.	
Exclusion #1	Combination therapy with other biologics (e.g. Cosentyx, Enbrel, adalimumab product, Kevzara, Remicade).
Approval Duration	
Initial	Simponi Aria (golimumab) will be approved in plan year durations or as determined through clinical review.
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Background
This is a prior authorization policy about Simponi Aria (golimumab). Black Box Warnings: - Increased risk of serious infections leading to hospitalization or death, including tuberculosis (TB), bacterial sepsis, invasive fungal infections (such as histoplasmosis) and infections due to other opportunistic pathogens. - Discontinue golimumab if a patient develops a serious infection. - Perform test for latent TB; if positive, start treatment for TB prior to starting golimumab. Monitor all patients for active TB during treatment, even if initial latent TB test is negative. - Lymphoma and other malignancies, some fatal, have been reported in children and adolescent patients treated with tumor necrosis factor (TNF) blockers, including golimumab.

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Combination therapy of Simponi Aria with methotrexate is recommended for the treatment of rheumatoid arthritis. Evidence from clinical trials in rheumatoid arthritis has found combination therapy more effective than Simponi Aria monotherapy. For psoriatic arthritis and ankylosing spondylitis, Simponi Aria may be used with or without methotrexate.

Simponi Aria (golimumab) can cause and/or should not be used in patients with:

- Clinically important active infections
- A history of tuberculosis, positive PPD
- Multiple sclerosis or other demyelinating events
- Undifferentiated cytopenias
- Malignancies
- Hematologic events
- Hepatosplenic T-cell lymphomas
- Hepatitis B Virus reactivation
- Hepatotoxicity
- Demyelinating disease – consider stopping Simponi Aria (golimumab) if exacerbation or new onset occurs.
- Biologics, including abatacept and anakinra
- Live vaccines- should not be given with Simponi Aria (golimumab).
- Therapeutic infectious agents - such as live attenuated bacteria (e.g. BCG bladder instillation for treatment of cancer) should not be given concurrently with Simponi Aria.

Monitoring:

Closely monitor patients for the development of signs and symptoms of infection during and after treatment with Simponi Aria. Discontinue if a patient develops a serious infection, an opportunistic infection, or sepsis. For patients who develop a new infection during treatment with Simponi Aria, perform a prompt and complete diagnostic workup appropriate for an immunocompromised patient and initiate appropriate antimicrobial therapy and closely monitor them.

TNF- α inhibitors have been associated cases of worsening congestive heart failure (CHF) and new cases of CHF. Simponi Aria (golimumab) has not been studied in patients with a history of CHF. If a decision is made to administer Simponi Aria (golimumab), these members should be closely monitored, and Simponi Aria (golimumab) should be discontinued at signs or symptoms of new or worsening CHF.

TNF- α inhibitors have been associated with cases of severe hepatic reactions including acute liver failure. In phase 3 clinical trials there were cases of ALT elevations ≥ 5 times ULN in 0.6% of golimumab treated patients. Many patients were taking medications that are known to cause increases in liver enzymes (i.e. NSAIDS, methotrexate) making the relationship between golimumab and liver enzyme elevation unclear.

Simponi Aria (golimumab) is a monoclonal antibody with human-derived antibody variable and constant regions against tumor necrosis factor (TNF) alpha.

Simponi Aria (golimumab) neutralizes the biologic activity of tumor necrosis factor (TNF)-alpha by binding and blocking its interaction with cell surface TNF receptors. Elevated TNF-alpha concentrations in the blood, synovium, and joints have been implicated in the pathophysiology of several chronic inflammatory diseases such as rheumatoid arthritis, psoriatic arthritis, and ankylosing spondylitis. Tumor necrosis factor-alpha is a naturally occurring cytokine that is involved in normal inflammatory and immune responses.

Simponi Aria (golimumab) is indicated for the treatment of adult patients with moderate to severe active rheumatoid arthritis (RA) in combination with methotrexate, patients 2 years of age and older with active psoriatic arthritis, adult patients with active ankylosing spondylitis and active

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polyarticular juvenile idiopathic arthritis in patients 2 years of age and older.

Simponi Aria (golimumab) is supplied as individually boxed-single use vials as 50mg/4ml vial of IV injection.

Provider Claim Codes

For medically billed requests, please visit www.humana.com/PAL. Select applicable Preauthorization and Notification List(s) for medical and procedural coding information.

Medical Terms

Simponi Aria; golimumab; Rheumatoid Arthritis; Psoriatic Arthritis; Ankylosing Spondylitis; Intravenous injection; pharmacy

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